

Technology News



OpenSolaris 2009.06 released

Sun Microsystems has released the OpenSolaris 2009.06 operating system, with significant improvements in networking, storage and virtualisation, in addition to performance enhancements and developer productivity updates. Central to the new release is the inclusion of Project Crossbow. As a follow on to the ZFS technology, Project Crossbow's complete re-architecture of the network stack becomes the new standard for how networking at the operating system level is done. It delivers the networking capability designed for virtualisation in combination with highly scaled, multiple-core, multi-threaded processors connected with extremely fast network interfaces.



New, fully integrated Flash storage support in ZFS helps in optimising large-scale pools of storage by designating Flash devices as write accelerators and read accelerators. These pools are automatically managed by ZFS to achieve extreme levels of performance across many workloads, making the need for small caches on RAID controllers obsolete.

Native support for Microsoft CIFS has been added as a full peer to NFS, as a high performance kernel with integrated features and support for Microsoft Windows semantics for security, naming and access rights, allowing transparent use and sharing of files across Windows, Linux and Solaris environments. In addition to this, the OpenSolaris platform delivers key server virtualisation technologies in the form of Solaris Containers, Logical Domains (LDoms) for Sun CMT systems and the Xen-based hypervisor to give users a complete virtualisation platform built directly into the OpenSolaris OS. To find more information on these technologies, visit opensolaris.com/learn.

Acer Aspire 5536 comes with Linux

Acer has rolled out the Aspire 5536 notebook based on the AMD Athlon X2 Dual-Core processor. The Aspire 5536 entertainment notebook harnesses the power AMD Athlon X2 Dual-Core processor and a high-quality HD graphics solution to deliver an improved multimedia performance. The notebook also features AMD's latest M780G chipset with ATI Radeon HD 4570 graphics, enabling what it claims is the ultimate visual experience on-the-go. The Aspire 5536 notebook features a 15.6" HD CineCrystal screen. In addition, the new range is equipped with floating keyboards and controls, a multi-gesture touchpad that comes with circular-motion scrolling for quick and seamless navigation, pinch-action for zoom-in and zoom-out, and page flip for browsing and flipping through Web pages and photos. Other specs include a 2 GB DDR3 1067 MHz, upgradeable up to 4 GB; a 320 GB HDD; a 8X DVD-Super Multi double-layer drive; a Dolby8-optimised surround sound system with two built-in stereo speakers; an integrated Acer Crystal Eye high-def webcam, featuring 640 x 480 @ 30 FPS; and a one year ITW. Available at all Acer Authorised Dealership and retail outlets, the Aspire 5536 Linux edition is priced at Rs 28,499.



LG to embed virtual desktop technology into monitors

LG Electronics is going to produce a new category of SmartVine N-series LCD monitors that include embedded 'virtualisation' technology from US-based NComputing Inc., enabling up to 11 people to share a single PC. These monitors will be marketed worldwide by LG beginning June. The sub-\$200 computing solution will bring its global distribution network to the alliance, while NComputing will contribute its hardware and vSpace virtualisation software. NComputing technology enables a single PC or server to be virtualised so that many users can tap the unused capacity.

LG's new flatscreen monitors will work with both Windows and Linux computers. Users connect their keyboards and mice directly to the monitor, which then connects to the host PC via a standard cable. An NComputing X550 PCI Card Kit with vSpace software enables the host PC to connect to five additional monitors. With two kits, a total of 11 users can share one PC.

In the United States, the LG SmartVine N-series line will include 17-inch (43.2 cm) and 19-inch (48.3 cm) class monitors (models N1742L-BF and N1941W-PF) covering both standard and widescreen resolutions. A 16-inch (40.6 cm) class model will also be available in other countries. All LG SmartVine N-series monitors can also be used as traditional monitors that connect through VGA for ultimate flexibility.